ETCSL 5.6.1 — The instructions of Šuruppag

- **Editors:** ETCSL project (J. Black, G. Cunningham, E. Robson, G. Zólyomi et al.), Oxford 1998–2006
- **URLs:** transliteration https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=c.5.6.1&display=Crit&charenc=gcirc ; translation https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=t.5.6.1 ; XML from OTA 2518 (see `../_bulk/`). ORACC: https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/epsd2/literary/Q000782
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-16 (live site down; HTML from Wayback Machine raw captures; XML from Oxford Text Archive)
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Why it matters here

Šuruppag, son of Ubara-Tutu, gives counsel to his son **Ziusudra** (l. 1–13, repeated at 73–82 and 143–152). Gilgameš XI 23 calls Uta-napišti 'man of Šuruppak, son of Ubara-Tutu' — the Akkadian tradition knows this lineage; an Akkadian version of the Instructions exists (Lambert BWL; Alster 2005). Earliest versions: Fara and Abu Ṣalābīḫ (ED IIIa, c. 2600 BC). Standard edition: Alster, *Wisdom of Ancient Sumer* (2005).

Files

- `b561--etcsl-bibliography.htm`
- `c.5.6.1--etcsl-cgi-transliteration.html`
- `c.5.6.1.xml`
- `t.5.6.1--etcsl-cgi-translation.html`
- `t.5.6.1.xml`
- `translation.md`
- `transliteration.md`

`transliteration.md` (288 composite lines) and `translation.md` are clean UTF-8 conversions of the XML (conventions at the top of each file); the `.xml` files are the authoritative source; the `--etcsl-cgi-*.html` files are the website display (Unicode, edition 2).

Line numbering

ETCSL composite line numbers (with segments/versions where the composition has them). Translation paragraphs carry the line range they cover.

ETCSL bibliography (secondary literature, from the XML header)

- Alster 1974a commentary, translation, composite text
- Alster 1987 commentary
- Alster 1990 commentary
- Civil 1984 ll. 95-138 commentary, translation
- Wilcke 1978 commentary, translation
- Alster 1992
- Alster 1997 568 translation, commentary ll. 266-268
- Alster 1997b 569-570 translation, commentary ll. 14-50, 153-164
- Römer 1990a 48-67 commentary, translation
- Civil 1989f composite text electronic source
- Krecher 1996 composite text electronic source
- Krecher 1996a composite text, translation electronic source
- Alster 1993a score transliteration, composite text, commentary electronic source
- Alster 1999a A, B commentary

Manuscripts listed by ETCSL

- A 645 (OIP 14 56) + A 649 (OIP 14 55; OIP 99 58)
- Ab?-T 393 (OIP 99 pl. 111f.; ib. pl. 113f.)
- AO 8899 (TCL 16 93)
- Ash 1932-156b (OECT 5 33)
- CBS 2203 (STVC 126; Alster ŠI pl. 9)
- CBS 4611 (PBS 10/1 4; Langdon Paradis pl. 9)
- CBS 8001 (Alster ŠI pl. 10)
- CBS 10320
- CBS 13107 (Alster ŠI 9)
- GE 45334
- KNMA 10054 (JCS 8 85)
- MDP 27 186
- MM 477
- N 901 (Alster ŠI 15)
- N 1833
- N 3260
- N 3298 (Alster ŠI 16; FTS fg. 61)
- N 3433 (Alster ŠI 17)
- N 3643
- ?N 3707

- N 3708 (Alster ŠI 15)
- N 3757 (Alster ŠI 17; FTS fg. 62 obv.)
- N 3774 (Alster ŠI 15)
- N 4148 (Mesopotamia 3 139)
- N 4329
- Ni 4001 (ISET 2 116)
- Ni 4152 (ISET 1 134)
- Ni 4271 (ISET 1 80)
- Ni 4543 (ISET 1 125)
- Ni 9558
- Ni 9559 (ISET 1 129)
- Ni 9612 (ISET 2 116)
- Ni 9731 (ISET 1 123)
- Ni 9778 (ISET 1 125)
- Ni 9793 (ISET 2 55)
- Ni 9820 (ISET 1 130)
- Ni 9884 (ISET 1 35)
- Ni 9917 (ISET 1 143)
- Ni 9928 (ISET 1 45)
- Ni 9985 (ISET 1 144)
- PRAK B 20
- UET 6 169 (Alster ŠI 1 coll.)
- UET 6 170 + U 7795A (Alster ŠI 2 coll.)
- UET 6 171 (Alster ŠI 2 coll.)
- UET 6 *59
- UET 6 *227
- UM 29-13-326 (+) UM 29-16-240 (Alster ŠI 5f.)
- UM 29-16-9 (Alster ŠI 3f.)
- VAT 10150 (KAR 27; BWL pl. 30) (bil.)
- 2N-T534 = IM 58969
- 3N-T123 = IM 58342
- 3N-T460 = A 30246 (+) 3N-T543 = A 30265 (Alster ŠI 8)
- 3N-T537 = IM 58539 (Alster ŠI 12)
- 3N-T549 = UM 55-21-345 (Alster ŠI 7)
- 3N-T722 = A 30293 (Alster ŠI 13f.)
- 3N-T756 = IM 58682
- 3N-T904,152
- 3N-T904,162
- 3N-T905,186
- 3N-T906,255

- … (71 in total; see `c.5.6.1.xml`)

Assessment

Standard free composite with translation; frozen in 2006 — check for newer manuscripts/editions (see `../../ORACC/` and the notes above).